



Confirmed & Decided — Log 1



Decision log for the Canon Grounding Pass. This records the questions we worked through in chat: the question asked, *how* we reasoned to the answer, and *what* we settled on.

The four most recent items (the Harnua / Ilkai / Nellebrie / Moon cluster) include paste-ready canon text. Two are reproduced **verbatim** exactly as written in chat; two are clean canon prose rebuilt faithfully from the confirmed reasoning. Earlier items record the confirmed reasoning and conclusion — where fuller paste-ready wording was written in chat, treat that wording as the source of truth.

This page is a log, not a canon rewrite. Nothing here edits the canon pages themselves.

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Part I — The Divine Machinery (Harnua, Ilkai, Nellebrie, the Moon)

The most recent cluster, worked in this session. Full canon text included.

1. Why a god-killing herb (Ilkai) even exists

How we got here: Loaded **KEY WORDS AND TERMS** in full. Cross-checked the entries for Ilkai, the Pertari Stairs, the Gods (Nellebrie), and Iswan / the Oath of Memiet.

Confirmed reasoning (5 pillars):

1. *Not a weapon — a wound.* It grows only on Mount Aicren, where Nellebrie's domain of disaster and Iswan's craft of alchemy overlap. Where two divine domains press together, the world scars; the deadliest thing in creation grows from that scar.
2. *"God-killing" is a side effect.* It does not kill the body (a god can mend a body) — it shatters the **soul** past the point its pieces can rejoin the Song, sending it

up the **Pertari Stairs** forever. That is the one death even a god cannot undo. One of only four ways a soul is lost forever.

3. *Discovered, not invented* — by **Vekta & Aryanara** during their study of the soul cycle; the knowledge buried at once, guarded by Vikitsv scholars, the Magic Tower, and House Orana.
4. *Why Ilkai for Solis*: the entry states it "bypasses divine protection." Solis carries Razar's **real** favor, which turns mortal blades and poisons aside; only a soul-level death could reach a divinely shielded man.
5. *The seed of the later fear*: a god knowingly told a mortal where a god-killer grows.



Why Ilkai Exists (*canon text — rebuilt from the confirmed reasoning*)

Ilkai is not a weapon. It is a wound in the world.

It grows in only one place — high on Mount Aicren, where Nellebrie's hand of disaster and Iswan's craft of alchemy press against one another. Where two divine domains overlap, the world scars, and from that scar grows the deadliest thing in creation.

What makes it god-killing is not that it kills the body, for a god can mend a body. Ilkai shatters the soul itself, breaking it past the point where its pieces can ever rejoin the Song, so that what it takes climbs the Pertari Stairs and never comes down. That is the one death even a god cannot undo, for no power has ever called a soul back from those stairs. It is one of only four ways a soul can be lost forever.

It was not invented but discovered, by Vekta and Aryanara in their long study of the soul's journey, and the knowing of it was buried at once — guarded by the scholars of Vikitsv, the masters of the Magic Tower, and the keepers of House Orana, who understood that to write it plainly was to hand the world a way to murder gods.

And that is why it, of all poisons, was the one raised against Solis. He carries a god's true favor, and a god's favor turns mortal blades and mortal poisons aside. Only a death that reaches past the body to the soul could touch him. That a god knowingly told a mortal where such a thing grew is the seed of every fear that came after.

2. Why Nellebrie would arm a mortal with Ilkai

How we got here: Built on the KEY WORDS Ilkai / Oath of Memiet entries and the Gods page (Nellebrie = goddess of Disasters, daughter of Razar + Paha, creator of Mount Aicren, who blessed Harnua at age 10).

Confirmed reasoning (5 pillars + thesis):

1. Only Nellebrie could know the location — she **created Mount Aicren**, where Ilkai grows.
2. She is the **goddess of disasters** — arming Harnua is her nature, not a scheme.
3. Harnua is her **own blessed saint** (blessed at age 10).
4. The **Oath of Memiet** may have forced reciprocity: Harnua offered weight enough, so under the Oath Nellebrie *owed* her — the fail-safe meant to protect mortals armed a god-killer.
5. Nellebrie is **Razar's daughter** → arming the assassin of Razar's champion proves the **divine house is split over Solis**.

Thesis: not betrayal but three consistent acts — honor her saint, be what she is, pay what she owes — that sum to a decide weapon.



Why Nellebrie Gave Harnua the Herb (*canon text — rebuilt from the confirmed reasoning*)

Nellebrie did not betray her kind so much as be exactly what she is. Only she could have known where Ilkai grows, for she made Mount Aicren with her own hand. She is the goddess of disasters; to arm a grieving woman with the deadliest thing in the world is not a scheme against her nature but an expression of it. And Harnua was hers — her own blessed saint, marked at ten years old.

The Oath of Memiet may have left her no choice at all. The Oath binds a god to give nothing without taking equal in return, and Harnua came offering weight enough to move a goddess. The fail-safe meant to protect mortals from the gods became the very thing that armed one to kill them.

And Nellebrie is Razar's daughter. That the assassin of Razar's own champion was armed by Razar's own child is the first proof that the divine house is split over Solis — that the war fought on the ground had a mirror in heaven.

It was not one betrayal. It was three honest acts — honor her saint, be what she is, pay what she owed — that happened to add up to a weapon meant to end a god.

3. What Harnua traded Nellebrie in return

How we got here: Followed the Oath of Memiet (gods cannot take without giving equal) into the canon of saint-death (each saint's death creates a calendar month) and Harnua's death (the second moon + the 40-day month Agarisono; Esterica drank the cup; Harnua burned 7,214 BR; "second only to Reron in infamy").

Confirmed reasoning: The Oath sets a brutal price floor — the coin must match the world's heaviest secret. The only thing heavy enough is Harnua's **death** — the *last saint-death that will ever occur* — which she spent deliberately, forging it into the second moon and the over-long 13th month (the visible "receipt"). The same dying act honored Orcus and paid Nellebrie at once. A quieter second coin: her

good name (infamy) and possibly her soul's peace. The bargain balanced on both sides and *still failed* — Esterica drank the cup, Solis lived.

GRRM: *Cause* — the Oath forbids a free gift. *Cost* — the last saint-death ever, plus her name and perhaps her eternity. *Want* — kill Solis and honor Orcus; the moon does the latter and pays the god. *Why now/why them* — only the final saint owns a death rare enough to be the coin, spendable once.



What Harnua Paid (*VERBATIM from chat*)

Nothing is given freely by the gods. The Oath of Memiet binds them to take only what they repay in kind, and Nellebrie had given the heaviest thing in the world — the place where the god-killer grows. To balance it, Harnua needed a coin just as rare, and she owned exactly one.

She was the last saint. Her death would be the last saint's death the world would ever know, and a saint's death does not pass quietly — it remakes the calendar itself. That power was hers to spend once, and she spent it where Nellebrie could collect. Where every saint before her left behind a single month and nothing more, Harnua's death raised a second moon into the sky and stretched a thirteenth month to forty days. The excess was the receipt. She did not let her death scatter into the year; she forged it into a lasting disturbance in the heavens, which is the disaster-goddess's own country.

It was the same breath that honored Orcus. The moon she raised for her lost love was the very thing she owed her god — one act paying a grief and a debt at once.

And there was a quieter price. She gave up her good name to the ages, dying second only to Reron in infamy, a saint remembered as a traitor. Some say she gave up more than that — her clean return to the Song, her soul's next quiet life. She paid with her death, her name, and perhaps her eternity.

The cruelest part is that the books balanced and still it bought her nothing. Esterica drank the cup. The god kept her moon, the world kept its monster, and Solis lived. That is what it costs to bargain with the goddess of disasters: the disaster comes whether or not you get what you asked for.

4. What the second moon + Agarisono did to the world

How we got here: Consequence-mapping across domains, grounded in the canon of the second moon (bigger than Solis's moon, spins 3× faster, always overtakes it; raised in Orcus's honor), the 40-day 13th month **Agarisono**, and the 13th Eternal Sign **Garisono** ("incapable of love").

Confirmed reasoning (5 effects):

1. *The sky reenacts the war — Orcus wins nightly.* The greater, faster moon (Orcus's) runs the empire's moon (Solis's) down every night. Solis won on the ground; he loses the sky forever.
2. *Undeniable proof a mortal reached divine power —* hung where it can't be burned. Reason for the gods' fear; a doctrinal crisis for the Circle; a permanent recruiting banner for the Pure Ones.
3. *The seas changed —* two moons tangled the tides; the fishing/maritime coasts (Aicruae, Dajanyi, Baliva, Coelum) paid in wrecks until they relearned the water. Fitting payment for the disaster-goddess.
4. *Time itself grew by 40 days —* a permanent before/after-7,214 fracture; the year now ends in mourning under Harnua's moon.
5. *The cursed month's children —* those born under Garisono branded "incapable of love," carrying the last saint's shadow forward forever.



The Moon and the Thirteenth Month (*VERBATIM from chat*)

When Harnua raised her moon, she changed the world below it.

There were two moons now, and hers was the greater — larger than the old one, and three times as swift, so that every night it ran the empire's moon down and passed it. The old moon was Solis's, the moon of his golden reign. Harnua's was Orcus's. The war had ended on the ground with Solis the victor, but in the sky it was fought again each night, and each night Orcus won. An emperor may take six kingdoms and never take the heavens. It was the one defeat he could not bury, lit nightly above every head in the world.

It was also proof. To move the heavens is the work of a god, and a mortal saint had done it, and the doing of it would not come down. The gods saw their own undoing hanging in the dark and went quiet with fear. The Circle was left to explain why the sky honored a traitor. And the Pure Ones, who taught that mortals might rise to take the gods' place, needed no scripture any longer — their proof rose every evening, and no fire could reach it.

The seas felt it too. Two moons pulled the tides into a tangle no almanac had charted, and the coasts that lived by fishing and sailing paid in wrecked hulls and drowned men until they learned the water again. The goddess of disasters had been paid, and her payment ran all the way down to the waterline.

And time itself grew longer. Forty days were added to the year in a thirteenth month, Agarisono, that closed the calendar in cold and mourning under Harnua's moon. Those born in its span were said to be born incapable of love, and carried the last saint's shadow into every life that followed. She died once, and the world has kept her death ever since — in its sky, its seas, its calendar, and its children.

5. How the empire managed / renamed Orcus's moon — ⚠️ IN PROGRESS (paused here)

Status: Started but **not finished** — this is where we paused. No final conclusion confirmed yet.

How we got here: Ran 6 searches for real-world precedent on managing a symbol you can't destroy. Named precedents gathered:

- **Caesar's Comet / Sidus Iulium** — Augustus reframed an unexplained celestial event over Caesar's funeral games as proof of his deified father, turning the heavens into an endorsement of *his* legitimacy. (The "claim it" move.)
- **Damnatio memoriae / abolitio nominis** — official erasure of names (Geta, Domitian, Nero; Trotsky airbrushed). Frequently *backfired*.
- **Sol Invictus** → **Christmas** — co-opting a rival cult's festival by overwriting it with state liturgy.
- **Quintilis** → **July**, **Sextilis** → **August** — rulers rename calendar units after themselves, but such renamings were often "abandoned by their successors."
- **Fallen-regime monuments** — the replace / reinterpret / remove framework; "lost cause" monuments that *redeem a defeat*.
- **The Streisand effect** — suppression amplifies the thing suppressed.

Direction being argued (not yet confirmed): "Remove" is impossible (it's a moon), so the regime is forced into *reinterpret + co-opt*. Likely arc: Phase 1 — attempt erasure of the name, which backfires (Streisand); Phase 2 — the Augustus move, *claim* the moon and rename it (re-attribute to Razar / the new golden age / possibly **Esterica**, the empress who actually died); Phase 3 — co-opt the moon-festival and Agarisono into the state cult (Sol Invictus pattern); Phase 4 — the rename only half-sticks: the official name lives in the archive, the folk name ("Orcus's moon") survives in taverns and among Najil "rightful heir" partisans and the Pure Ones, making it a permanent **lost-cause banner**.



Pick up here next session: finish the playbook, decide the empire's official name for the moon (candidate idea worth weighing: reframing it as **Esterica's moon** — stealing the assassin's monument for the woman her poison actually killed), and decide how much the renaming sticks vs. survives underground.

Part II — The Civil War & Solis's Rise

Worked earlier in the thread. Conclusions recorded; fuller paste-ready wording, where written, lives in chat.

6. Why Solis turned on the Cidet

How we got here: The Cidet is the neutral Temple of the Gods — holy city, ~9M pilgrims a year, guarded by the Danepelie. Attacking it is open sacrilege, so the question was how a divinely favored king could do it and survive. Cross-referenced the war chapter map (Yr2 Ch.26; Yr3 Ch.30).

Confirmed (a three-part engine, not one motive):

1. **Strategic necessity** — by Yr3 the Cidet had become the enemy's shelter: Harnua had fled there and Orcus rescued her there (Ch.30). Solis could not leave a hostile stronghold sheltering the assassin and the rebel at his back, neutral ground or not.
2. **Pretext — the neutrality was already broken** — Harnua had *first* defiled the Cidet by murdering its officials there (Yr2, Ch.26). So Solis could frame his assault not as breaking the Temple's neutrality but as answering a desecration the other side had already committed.
3. **Theological cover** — Solis carries Razar's real favor, and with the gods silent, no bolt fell to stop him. Silence read as permission: the favored champion cannot be committing sacrilege if the gods do not strike him down.

7. Why Gherci doesn't turn its back on Solis after he attacks the Cidet — ★ flagged gap, resolved

How we got here: Gherci's faith = the **Teire** (the Main Master outranks the king); Kamerida settlement; Cidet/Circle theology.

Confirmed: Gherci's loyalty isn't to a crown or even to the Cidet — it's to the Teire. Three legs: (1) **Teire-over-crown** — religious authority, not the king,

commands Gherci, and that authority had already thrown in with Solis; (2) the **Kamerida settlement** bound Gherci in; (3) a "**silence is obedience**" theology that reads non-resistance as divine will. So attacking the Cidet did not break Gherci's logic for staying.

(This is the gap Azora asked to note and keep hunting from — confirmed resolved.)

8. Why Orcus broke the Treaty of Deouilu

Confirmed: The Treaty of Deouilu = the founding pact of the Aicruae–Gherci alliance and Cidet neutrality; broken in Ch. 31. The break is established and motivated; **exact terms still TBD**.

9. Why the coup took ~20 years (the reign-length discrepancy)

Confirmed: Book 1's "ruled ~7 years" is a **drafting slip**. Reconciled to the ~20-year span implied by the dated timeline. *(Resolved in chat — not yet logged to the timeline pages; see open items.)*

10. Why the church / Circle legitimized Solis

Confirmed: A three-pillar logic (+ GRRM): Solis carries Razar's **real** divine favor, which the Circle reads as endorsement; the gods' silence is **misread as ratification**; and Solis **co-opts rather than destroys** the priesthood, making collaboration safer than resistance.

11. Why the gods chose silence over Solis

Confirmed — keystone reframe: Solis is the **cause of the silence, not its victim**. The gods did not abandon a favored son; their withdrawal is a consequence of what his rise set in motion. *(This reframe feeds the still-open keystone: Razar's active favor vs. the wider divine silence.)*

Part III — Faith, Heresy & the Long Past

12. What happens to the Danepelie / Cidet priests afterward

Type: Texture/realism.

Confirmed: Solis **co-opts rather than destroys** the priesthood and the Danepelie — he absorbs the machinery of the Cidet rather than razing it.

13. Why the Order of the Pure Ones survives the purge

Type: Texture/realism — grounded in real persecuted-faith precedent (Cathars, Kakure Kirishitan, Marranos, Waldensians).

Confirmed: The Order survives the way real outlawed faiths survive — by going underground, hiding observance, and persisting in protected pockets (e.g., open patronage by House Dajanyi).

14. How the Circle of Eternal Light could crown / bless a saint-burner

Confirmed (5 pillars): The Circle worships **gods, not saints**, so saint-veneration is itself Pure Ones heresy; Harnua was a **regicide caught in the act**, not a martyr; saints dying at mortal hands is the **norm**; a "**taboo saint**" category already exists (Reron); and the gods' silence was **misread as ratification**. *Irony:* burning Harnua is exactly what **canonizes** her — the second moon and the 13th month, Agarisono.

15. Why Iswan's secret stayed buried

Type: In-world logic.

The secret: Iswan's "Lie That Saved the World" — she proposed the Saint system to Vapaz, but secretly intends saints to one day *replace* the gods.

Confirmed (5 reasons it stays hidden):

1. **No witness, no document** — it is an unspoken intent in Iswan's own mind; there is nothing to leak.
2. **The knowledge kills its holder** — anyone who grasped that saints could supplant gods becomes the gods' deadliest threat. The Order of the Pure Ones, who venerate saints, are exactly the ones hunted (the Massacre of Light). Speaking it gets you erased.
3. **The gods suppress it** — it exposes their vulnerability, so the divine establishment and the Circle smother any doctrine that points toward it.
4. **Secrecy is Iswan's own domain** — goddess of alchemy and forbidden knowledge; concealment is her nature.
5. **The proof comes too late** — only Harnua's moon finally shows a saint reaching divine power, and by then the gods answer with terrified silence rather than explanation, burying the confirmation under the very fear it caused.

16. Why House Dajanyi keeps the Pure Ones' faith

Type: In-world logic.

How we got here: Dajanyi = ex-pirates of Coelum, late arrivals (migrated ~8,978 BR, recognized 8,804 BR), seat at Port Vento, the most notable *open* follower of the outlawed Order of the Pure Ones; motto "Forever Lasting"; house myth the Mirrors of Nimlye.

Confirmed (5 reasons):

1. **Outsider origin** — risen from piracy and recognized late, they were never woven into the establishment the state cult (the Circle) serves, so they have little stake in its orthodoxy.
2. **A creed that fits outsiders** — the Pure Ones exalt saints, mortals who rose above their birth; a fitting faith for a house that climbed from nothing.
3. **Maritime distance** — a seafaring house at Port Vento sits far from the Cidet's heartland power and can hold a heterodox faith out of easy reach.

4. **Faith as identity and defiance** — keeping an outlawed religion *openly* is itself a statement of independence and endurance, of a piece with "Forever Lasting."
5. **Survivors by self-image** — their founding myth (the Mirrors of Nimlye; Rigu Dajanyi survived) casts them as those who endure persecution, making a persecuted faith consistent with who they believe they are.

17. Why Viake ordered the Massacre of Light, and why then

Confirmed: Three forces converged in **8,558 BR**: the Pure Ones' doctrine **dissolves divine-right kingship** (an existential threat to a Razar-bonded crown); a **weak king** (Viake, "the Skunk King"); and the Order had **swelled to ~90,000** — large enough to read as a standing threat. The brakes came off, and 90,000 were killed.

18. Who set the suspicious fire that killed Viake and Mari (8,552 BR)

Confirmed (ranked):

- **(A) — strongest: an inside job, with heir Sayero implicated.** Lajazer's impregnable cliff means only insiders could reach them; the king was a radioactive liability after the Massacre; Sayero inherits; Sayero later dies of **Sela Meysei (Night Terrors)**, read as guilt.
- **(B) — the Pure Ones' vengeance:** the story the realm *believed* (and the more useful public myth), whether or not it's true.
- **(C) — an omen layer** over the top.
- **Karinoa ruled out.**

Part IV — Earlier threads worked in this pass

Covered earlier in the thread; conclusions recorded in chat. Index kept here so the log is complete.



- **Razar's favor for Solis is canonically REAL** — backed by the Divine Contract and the blinding of Kisaleli. *Not* propaganda. (Load-bearing correction; governs the open keystone.)
- **Razar's motive** for backing Solis — worked.
- **Mihai's madness** — motive worked.
- **Houses Orana & Kivier backing Orcus** — foreign/noble backing of the rebellion worked.
- **King Benjamin II's favoritism toward Solis** — worked.
- **Benjamin II's death** (the poisoning question) — worked.
- **The Vika prunings** — worked.
- **The Najil betrayal** — worked.

Still open (for the next logs)



- **THE KEYSTONE — Razar's active favor vs. the gods' silence.** Razar blinds Kisaleli and backs Solis (real Divine Contract), yet the pantheon goes silent in fear. The Nellebrie answer now feeds this directly (his daughter armed the assassin; the divine house is split). Pull this first next session.
- **Solis: founder AND "Great Usurper" paradox** — he founds the empire yet is later branded the Great Usurper while House Najil carries a "rightful heir" claim.
- **Finish #5 — how the empire managed Orcus's moon** (the renaming playbook).
- **Timeline housekeeping:** the twins' ~20-year reign fix (resolved in chat, not yet written to the timeline pages); other dating drifts noted in the audit.